The direct impact of terrorism was felt again in March 2009 when Sri Lanka's cricket team was attacked by twelve gunmen in Lahore in the middle of a busy intersection. This became the last international cricket match Pakistan was able to host until 2017. The incident was followed by the attack on the Manawan Police Academy when gunmen armed with automatic weapons, grenades and rockets took over the main building during a morning parade. In October the same police academy was attacked again as part of a larger attack on three government buildings including the Elite Force Training Academy and the Federal Investigation regional headquarters in Lahore.

It was not only the security services that suffered. Life for ordinary civilians changed beyond recognition due to the roadblocks and the constant blast and threats of suicide attacks. The twin suicide attacks on Islamabad's International Islamic University in October 2009 killed six and injured twenty-nine (twenty-five were women) while over three thousand students were in the building. The first blast occurred next to the cafeteria and close to the girls' hostel, the second one only minutes later near the Sharia and law department. This attack changed things across the board for all education institutions. All schools and colleges closed to work on security improvements for several weeks. Private schools across the country employed security personnel while many government schools were issued with security cameras to monitor gates. Elite private institutions took extra security measures, hiring snipers for the protection of their students. Later that year, in December, two very large bomb blasts rocked the city in the Moon Market of Lahore's Allama Iqbal Town. The attack took place at 9 p.m., catching many who had changed their shopping habits to late evenings so as to avoid possible bomb attacks. It is estimated that 54 people were killed and well over 150 injured. This marked the end of a bloody year for Lahore that had seen regular terror attacks since the end of Ramadan that year in September.

In Karachi, Pakistan's commercial capital that generates around 70 per cent of national GDP, prior to 2004 violence had been the result of political turf wars between the MQM, Sindhi groups and the Pashtun Awami National Party (ANP). Many of the issues emanated from growing inequalities, the state's incapacity to meet the needs of the citizens in a growing megacity, and the growing influence of political gangs. Most of Karachi's katchi abadis (slums) are ethnically segregated with particular groups controlling different areas and industries; there is a roaring black-market economy worth over 830 million rupees generated by land mafia, police corruption, illegal gambling and the water mafia. '*You know Parveen Rehman (the Orangi Project person)*[22] *was killed*